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University of Wollongong

CSIT321 - Final Year Project

News Release System Design and Implementation

Supervisor: <REDACTED>

Group Number: <REDACTED>

Group Members:

Name	UOW ID	SIM ID	SIM E-Mail Address
roshitha05	<REDACTED>	<REDACTED >	<REDACTED>
<REDACTED>	<REDACTED>	<REDACTED >	<REDACTED>
<REDACTED>	<REDACTED>	<REDACTED >	<REDACTED>
<REDACTED>	<REDACTED>	<REDACTED >	<REDACTED>
<REDACTED>	<REDACTED>	<REDACTED >	<REDACTED>

Preliminary User Manual

Version Control

Document Information

Prepared By	roshitha05 <REDACTED>
Date Prepared	10/09/2026
Reviewed By	<REDACTED> (Project Supervisor)

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11/09/2026	1.0	roshitha05 <REDACTED>	Initial version of the Preliminary User Manual

Distribution List

Name	Position / Responsibilities	Organisation
<REDACTED>	Project Supervisor	University of Wollongong
Roshitha05	Documentation, Backend Developer, Unit tester	S3-22, University of Wollongong
<REDACTED>	Documentation, Database Designer, Unit Tester	S3-22, University of Wollongong
<REDACTED>	Project leader, Documentation, Developer, Software Tester	S3-22, University of Wollongong
<REDACTED>	Documentation, Frontend Developer, Unit Tester	S3-22, University of Wollongong
<REDACTED>	Documentation, Developer, Unit Tester	S3-22, University of Wollongong

Table of Content

University of Wollongong	1
CSIT321 - Final Year Project.....	1
News Release System Design and Implementation	1
Version Control.....	3
Document Information	3
Version History	4
Distribution List	5
Table of Content	6
1. Introduction	1
1.1 Prerequisites	1
1.2 Accessing the News Release System	1
1.3 Initial Installation Instructions	1
End-user installation	1
Prototype deployment for the project team	2
1.4 Initial Configuration and First-Time Setup	2
Admin initial configuration.....	2
1.5 Initial GUI Guide.....	3
2. Web Dashboard	3
3. Guest User	3
4. Registered User.....	9
5. System Admin	18
3. Troubleshooting	27

1. Introduction

This User Manual provides instructions for using the News Release System. It explains how Guests, Registered Users and System Admins can access and use the functions available to their respective roles.

The manual provides step-by-step guidance for the main functions of the system, including browsing and searching for news, managing user preferences, interacting with articles, publishing and managing news content, and performing administrative functions.

As the system is currently under development, this preliminary manual documents the functions available in the current prototype and may be updated as additional features are implemented.

1.1 Prerequisites

The News Release System is a web-based application. Before accessing the system, users should have:

- A device with access to the Internet.
- A stable Internet connection.
- A supported web browser.
- A registered account for functions restricted to Registered Users or System Admins.

Guests do not require an account to browse and read publicly available news articles.

1.2 Accessing the News Release System

1. Open a supported web browser.
2. Enter the URL of the News Release System into the browser address bar.
3. The News Release System home page will be displayed.
4. Guests may begin browsing publicly available news content, while Registered Users and System Admins may log in to access additional functions.

1.3 Initial Installation Instructions

End-user installation

The News Release System is a web-based application. Guests and Registered Users do not need to install a desktop or mobile application. They need a supported web browser, an Internet connection and the system URL supplied by the project team.

1. Open a supported browser such as Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Safari or Firefox.

2. Enter the News Release System URL in the address bar.
3. Wait for the home dashboard to load. If the page does not open, confirm the Internet connection and URL.
4. Guests can begin browsing immediately. Account-based functions require registration and login.

Prototype deployment for the project team

The project team must create or select the Supabase project, run the approved database scripts, enable the required authentication settings, create the media storage bucket, configure the frontend with the Supabase project URL and public anonymous key, and serve the frontend from the approved development or hosting environment. Secret service-role keys must not be placed in browser code.

1.4 Initial Configuration and First-Time Setup

The current prototype does not contain a separate automated setup wizard. The following guided sequence provides the equivalent first-time user setup.

1. Open the application and select Register.
2. Enter the required account information and submit the registration form.
3. Complete email verification if it is enabled for the prototype environment.
4. Log in using the registered email address and password.
5. Open Preferences or Interests and select the news categories that the user wants to follow.
6. Save the selections. The system stores them under the authenticated user account.
7. Return to the home dashboard and confirm that personalised or category-based content can be accessed.

Admin initial configuration

1. Log in using an authorised System Admin account.
2. Open Category and Tag Management and review the initial classification list.
3. Create any categories or tags required for the first set of news articles.
4. Review the available news content and confirm that only published articles appear to public users.
5. Open the analytics area and confirm that the dashboard loads before operational use.

1.5 Initial GUI Guide

The following sections show the initial graphical interfaces for Guests, Registered Users and System Admin. Each screenshot should be read together with its section heading and caption. Functions marked as planned may change as the prototype is completed

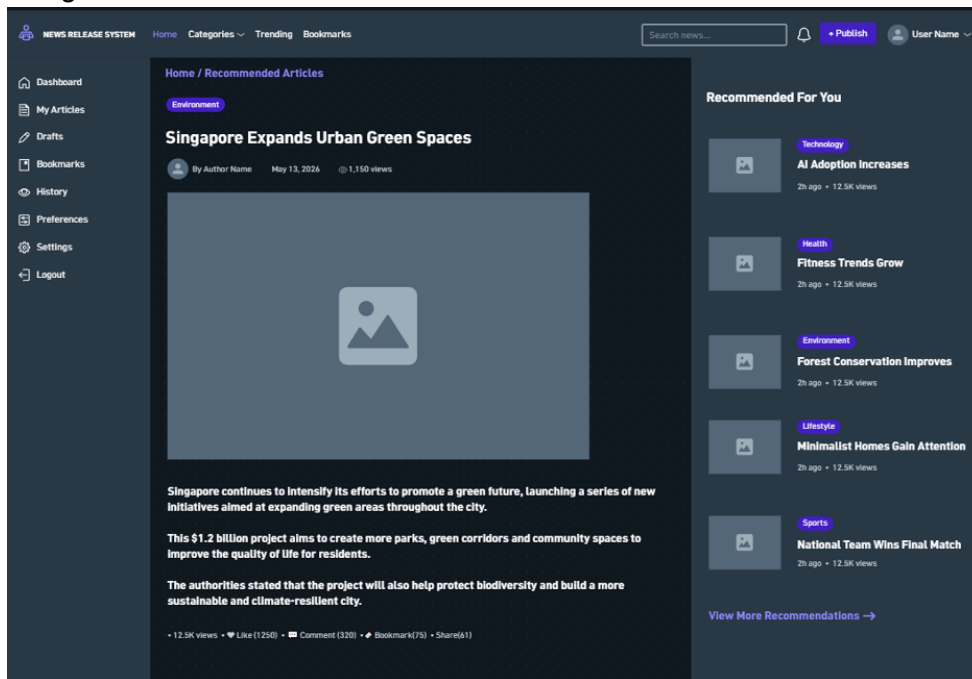
2. Web Dashboard

3. Guest User

This section provides instructions for functions that can be accessed without registering or logging into the News Release System.

3.1 Browse and Read News Articles

All users can browse and read published news articles without creating an account or logging in. News articles can be accessed from the homepage or other news sections available through the navigation menu.



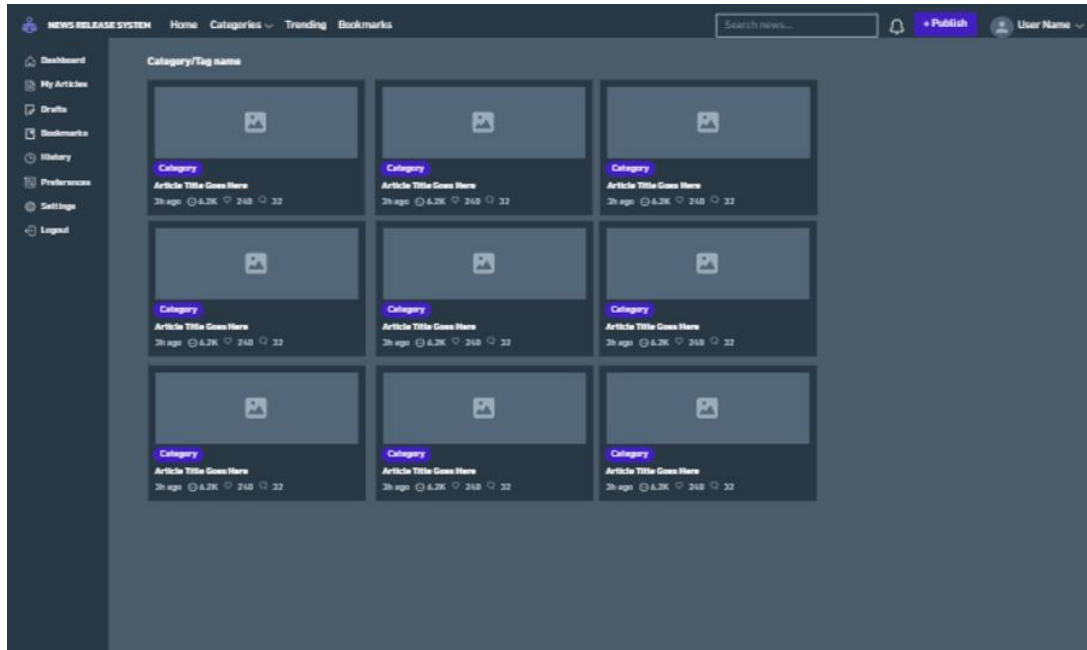
Steps:

1. Access the News Release System.
2. Browse the available news articles displayed on the page.
3. Select the title or article card of the news article you wish to read.
4. The selected news article will be displayed with its full content.

5. Scroll through the page to continue reading the article

3.2 Browse News by Category and Tag

All Users can browse news articles according to categories and tags. This allows the users to narrow down the displayed articles and find news related to a particular topic.



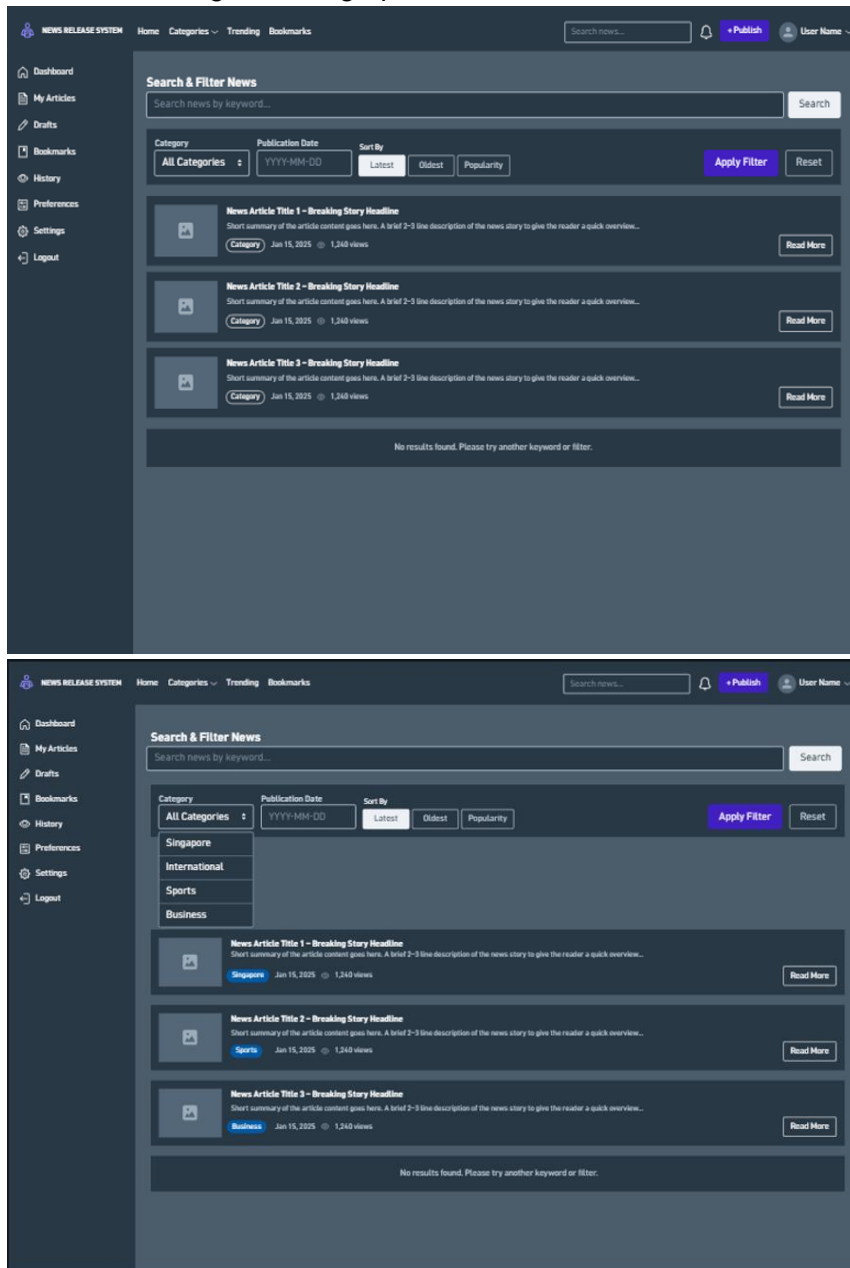
Steps:

1. Access the News Release System.
2. Select a news category or tag from the available options.
3. The system displays news articles associated with the selected category or tag.
4. Browse the displayed articles.

Select an article to view its full content.

3.3 Search, Filter and Sort News

Users can search for news articles using keywords and refine the displayed results using the available filtering or sorting options.



Steps:

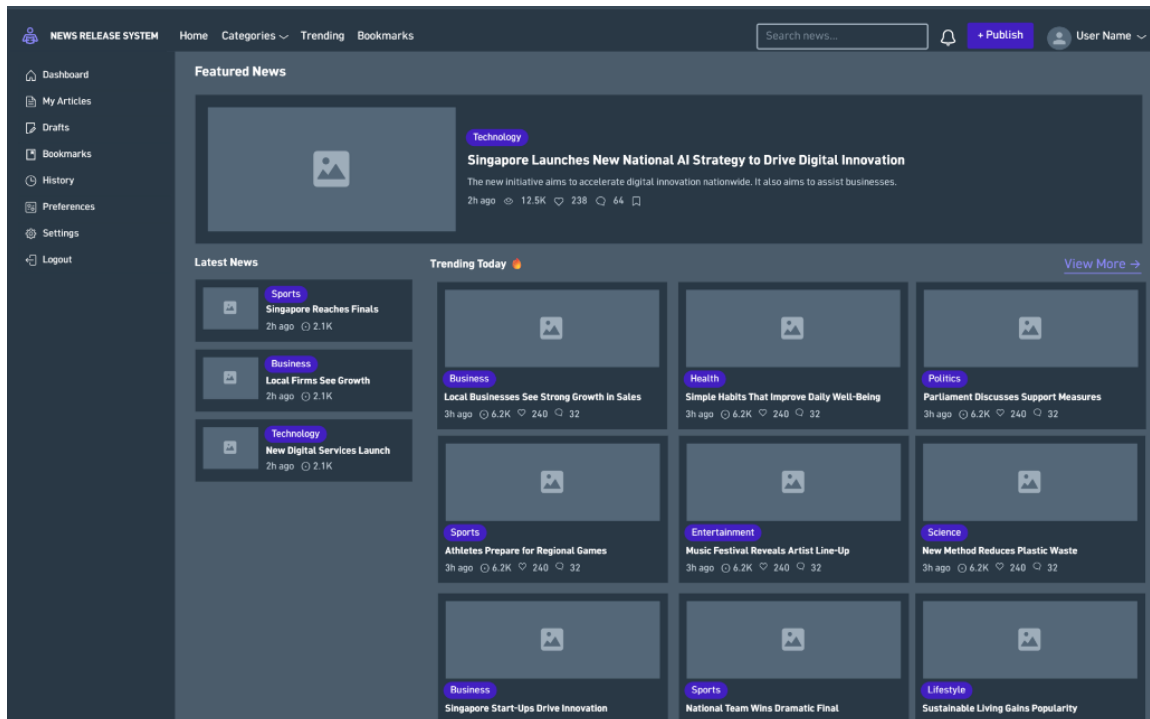
1. Select the search bar.
2. Enter a keyword related to the desired news article.
3. Select Search.
4. The system displays the matching news articles.
5. Select a filtering or sorting option, if required.

6. The system displays filtered or sorted news articles.

If no matching articles are found, the system displays a “No results found” message.

3.4 View Trending and Popular News

Guest Users can view news articles that are currently trending or popular on the News Release System. This provides quick access to articles receiving higher levels of user attention and engagement.



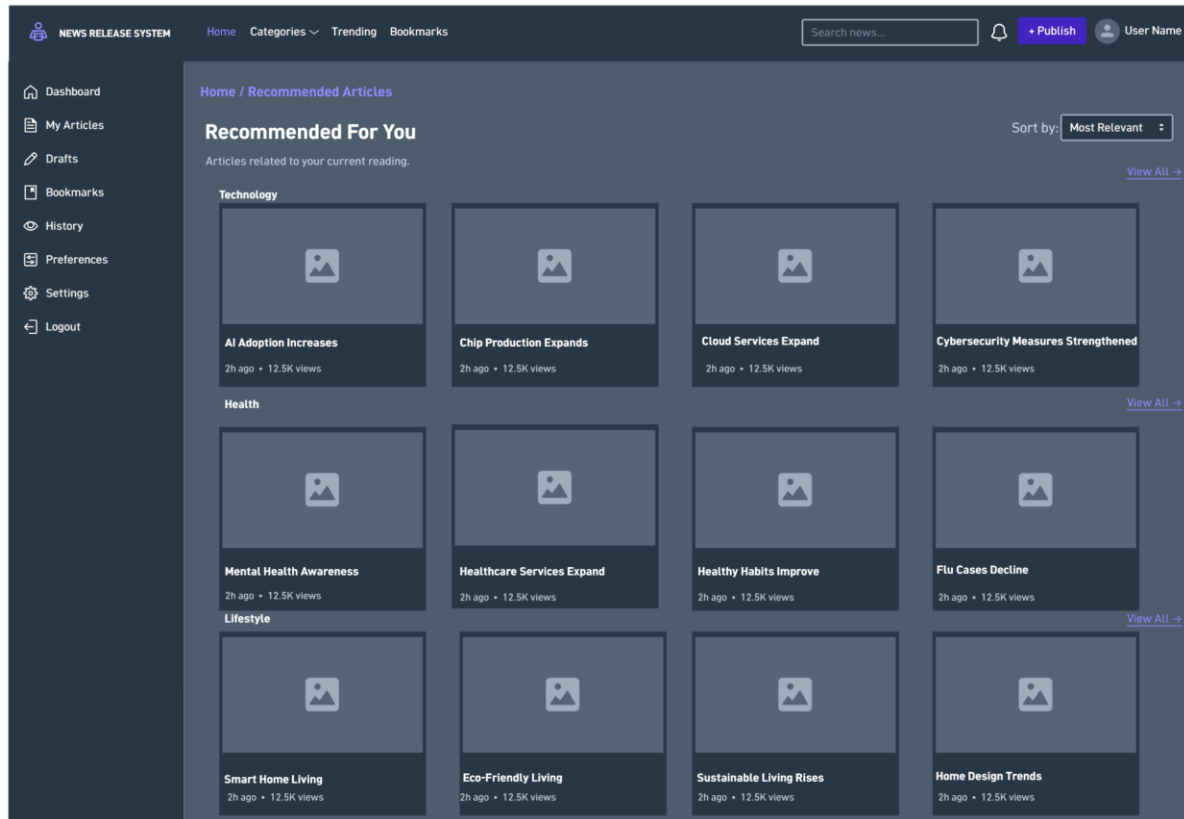
Steps:

1. Access the News Release System.
2. Navigate to the Trending and Popular News section.
3. View the articles displayed under the trending or popular news sections.

Select an article to view its full content.

3.5 View Recommended News

Guest Users can view recommended news articles related to the article they are currently reading. Recommendations allow users to discover other news content covering similar categories or topics.



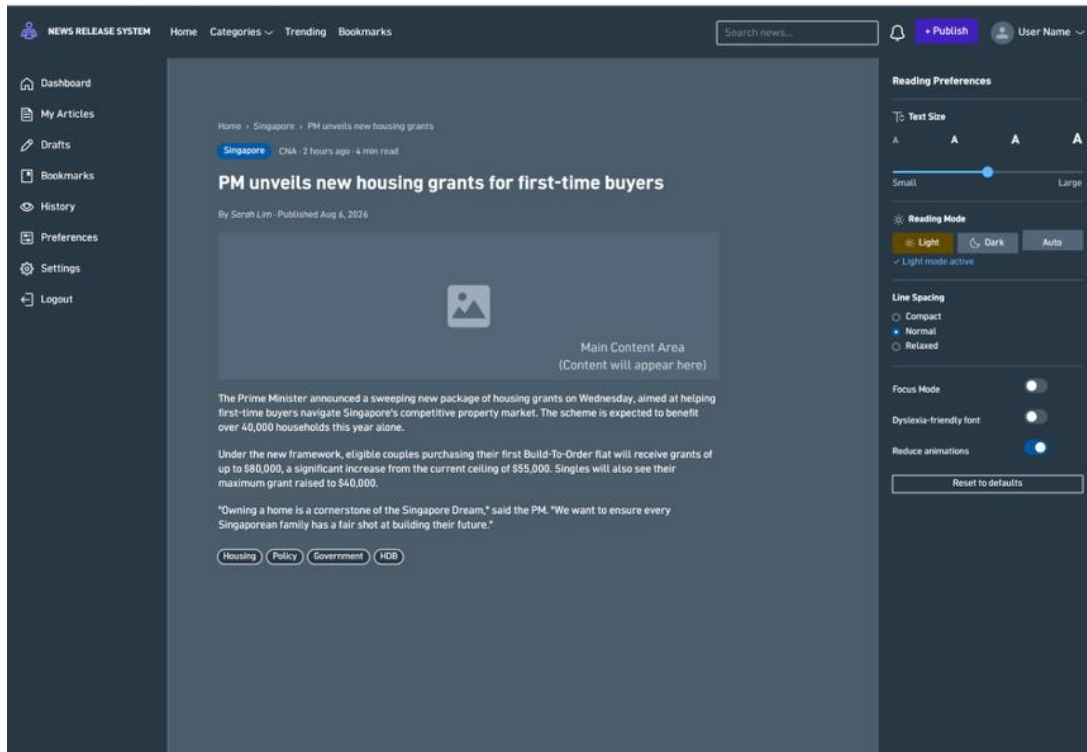
Steps:

1. Select and open a published news article.
2. Read or scroll through the selected article.
3. Locate the recommended news section.
4. Browse the recommended articles displayed.

Select a recommended article to open and read it.

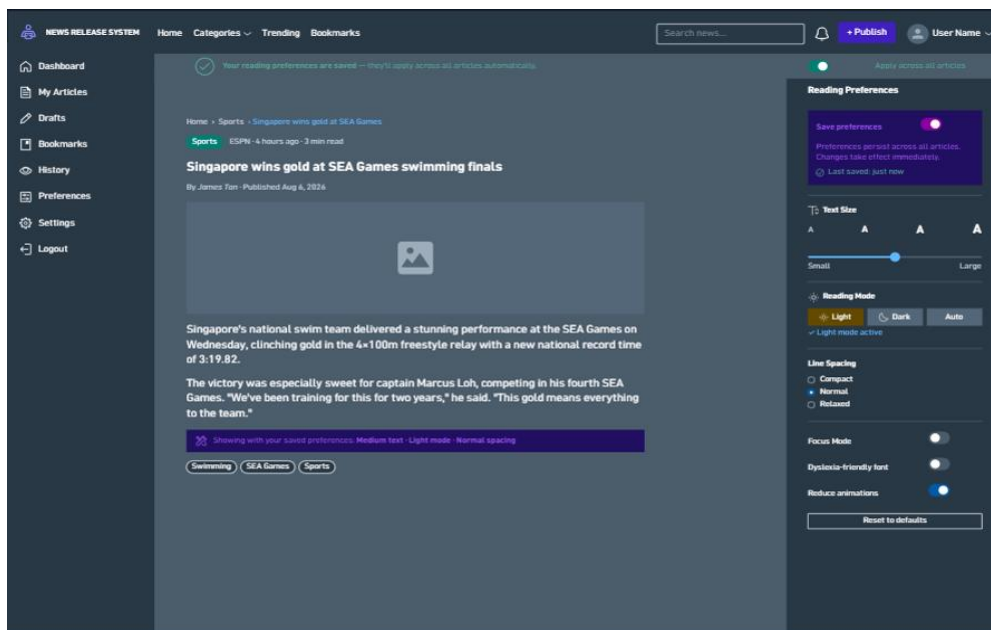
3.6 Adjust Reading Settings

Guest Users can adjust the available reading settings to improve the readability of news content according to their preferences. This includes changing the text size and selecting the preferred display mode.



Steps:

1. Open the available reading or accessibility settings.
2. Select the preferred text size.
3. Select the preferred light or dark mode.
4. The selected settings are applied to the interface.
5. Continue browsing or reading news articles using the selected settings.

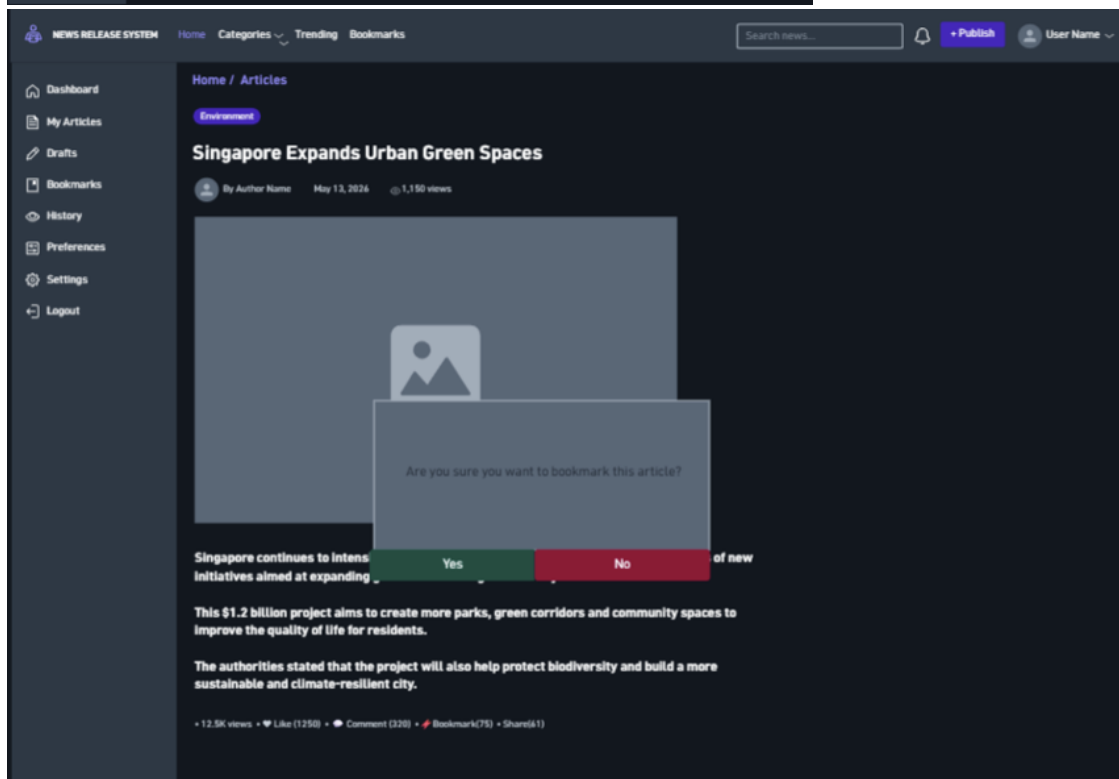
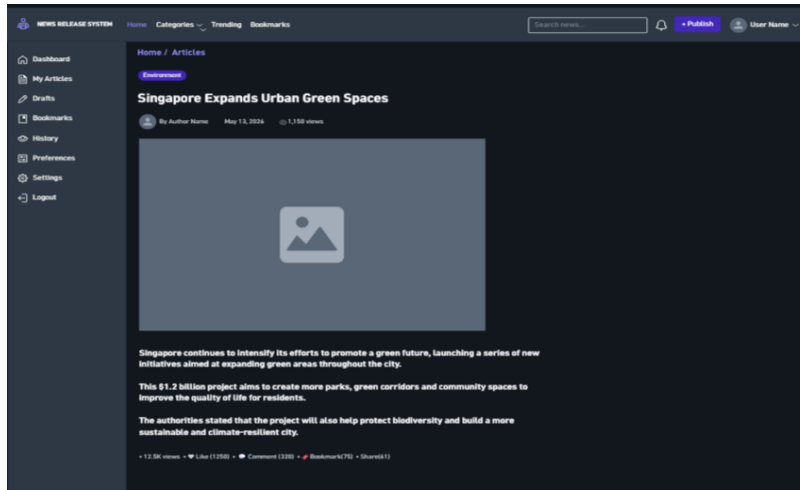


4. Registered User

Registered Users can access the functions available to Guests together with additional functions for interacting with, personalising and contributing news content.

4.1 Bookmark an Article

Users can register for an account to access additional functions that are not available to Guest Users. A registered account allows users to interact with news content, manage preferences and publish their own articles

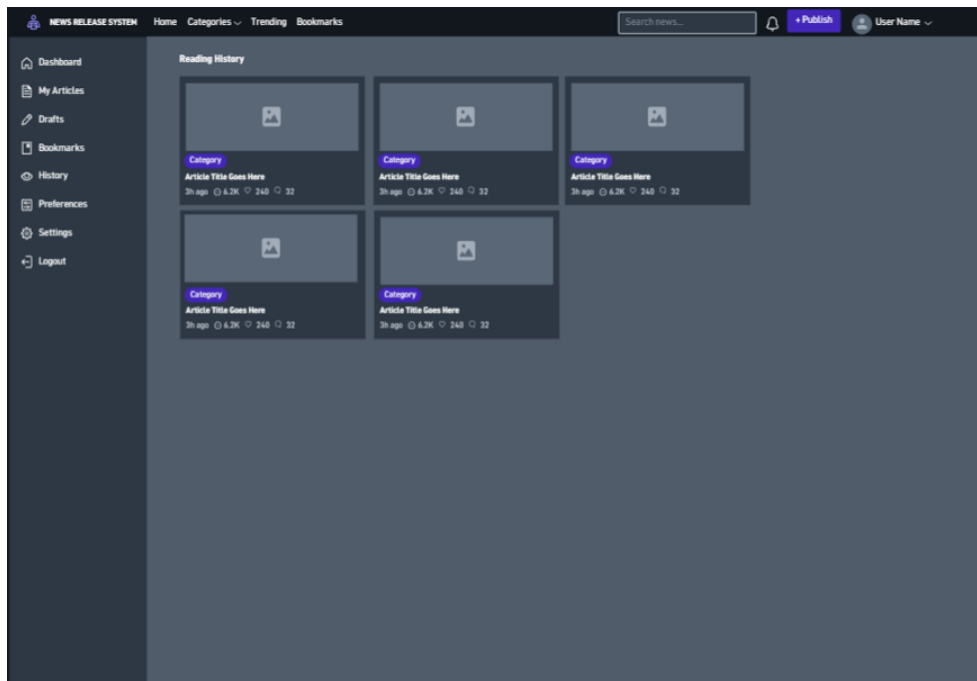


Steps:

1. Select Register from the News Release System.
2. Enter the required account information.
3. Check that the entered information is correct.
4. Select Register to create the account.
5. The system displays a confirmation when the account is successfully created.
6. The user can proceed to log in using the registered account.

4.2 View Reading History

Registered Users can view their reading history to access news articles that they have previously read.



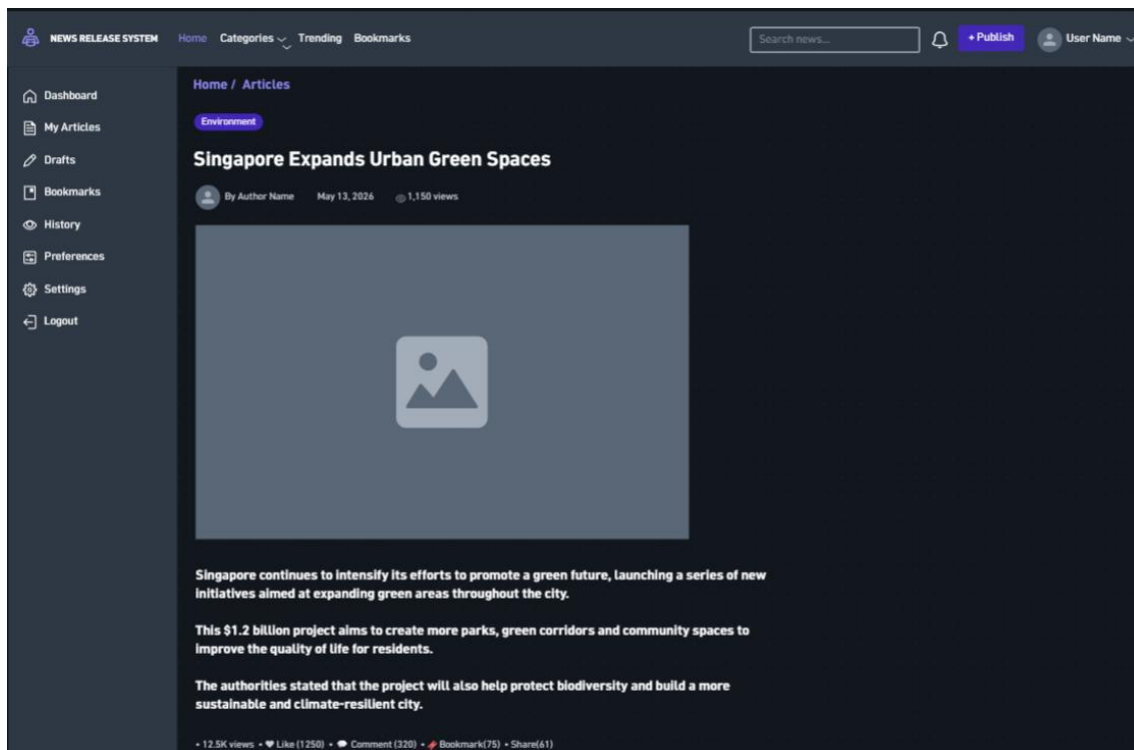
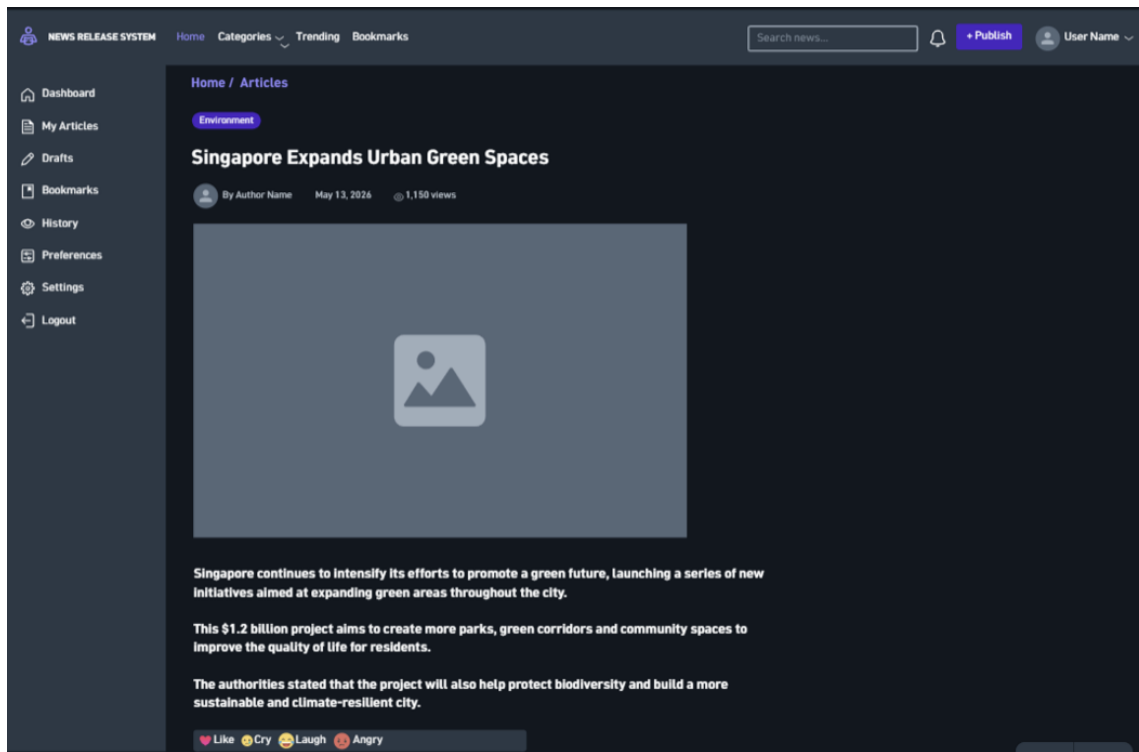
Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
2. Navigate to the Reading History section.
3. View the list of previously read news articles.
4. Select an article from the reading history.

The selected article will be displayed for reading.

4.3 React to a News Article

Registered Users can react to published news articles to express their response to the content.

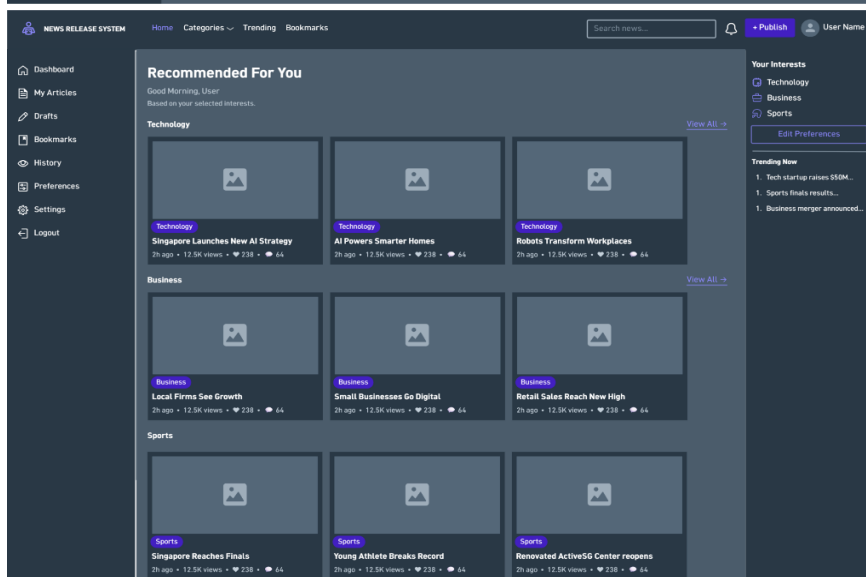
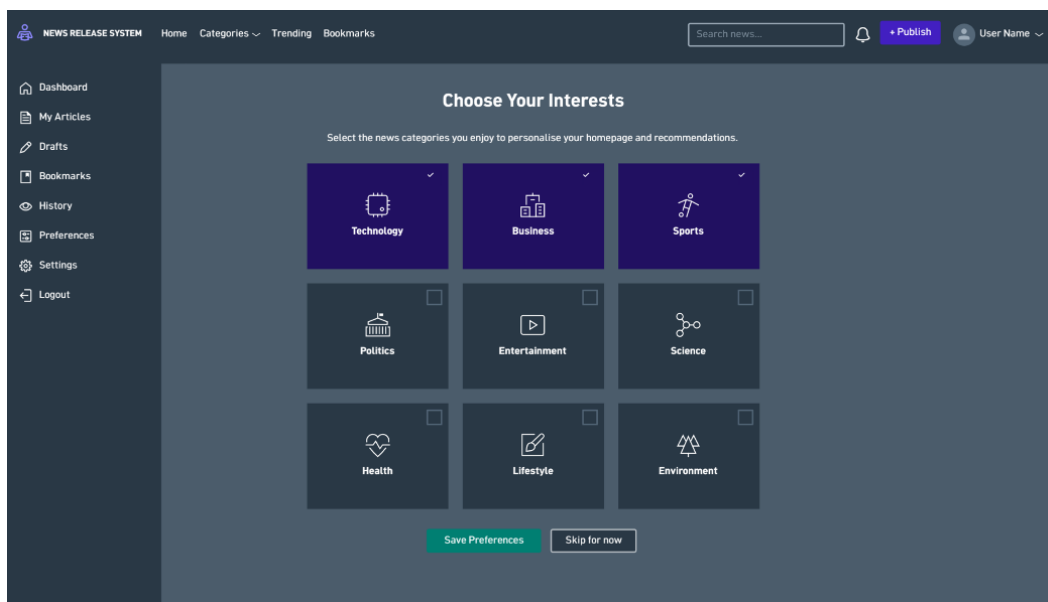


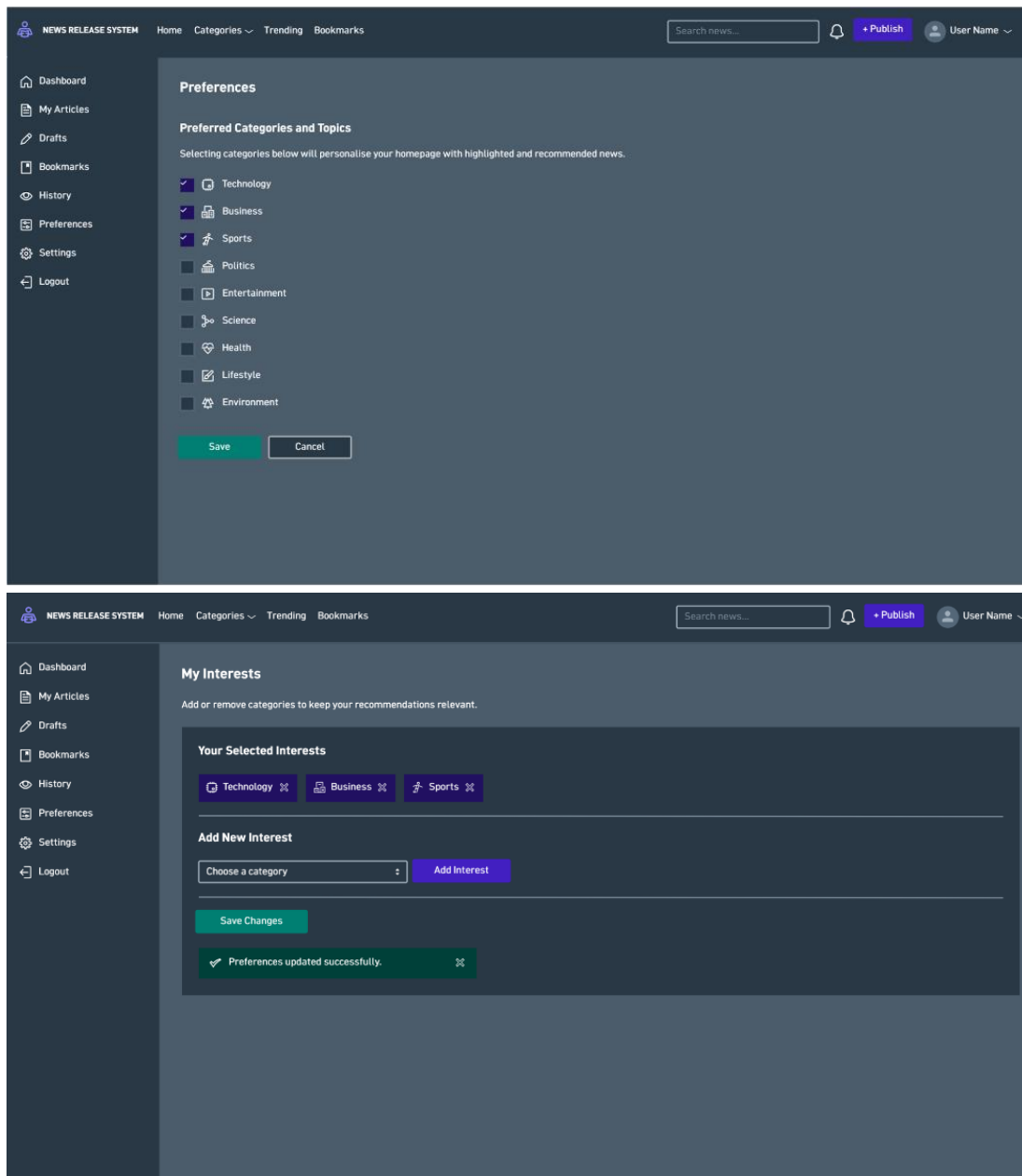
Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
2. Open the news article you wish to react to.
3. Locate the available reaction options.
4. Select the preferred reaction.
5. The selected reaction is recorded and reflected on the article.

4.4 Manage News Preferences and Interests

Registered Users can select and manage their preferred news categories or interests. These preferences are used to provide a more personalised news browsing experience.





Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
 2. Navigate to the Preferences or interests section.
 3. View the available news categories.
 4. Select or deselect categories according to your interests.
 5. Select Save to update the preferences.
 6. The system displays a confirmation when the preferences are successfully saved.
- Create a News Article

The screenshot shows the 'Create/publish article' interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM', 'Home', 'Categories', 'Trending', and 'Bookmarks'. A search bar labeled 'Search news...' and a '+ Publish' button are on the right. A sidebar on the left contains links: 'Dashboard', 'My Articles', 'Drafts', 'Bookmarks', 'History', 'Preferences', 'Settings', and 'Logout'. The main form area has the title 'Create/publish article'. It includes an 'Article title:' label with a text input containing 'Example article'. Below that is an 'Upload image:' label with an 'Upload' button. The 'Article content:' label is followed by a large text area containing 'Example content'. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Save as draft' and 'Publish article'.

Registered Users can create their own news articles by entering the required article information and content.

4.5 Add Media to a News Article

Registered Users can add media, such as images, to their news articles to support and enhance the article content.

The screenshot shows the 'Image preview' section of the interface. The top navigation bar and sidebar are identical to the previous screenshot. The main content area is titled 'Image preview'. It features a 'Preview:' label above a square image placeholder with a small landscape icon. Below the preview is a 'Change image:' label with a 'File' button. At the bottom of this section is a 'Confirm submission:' label with a green 'Upload' button.

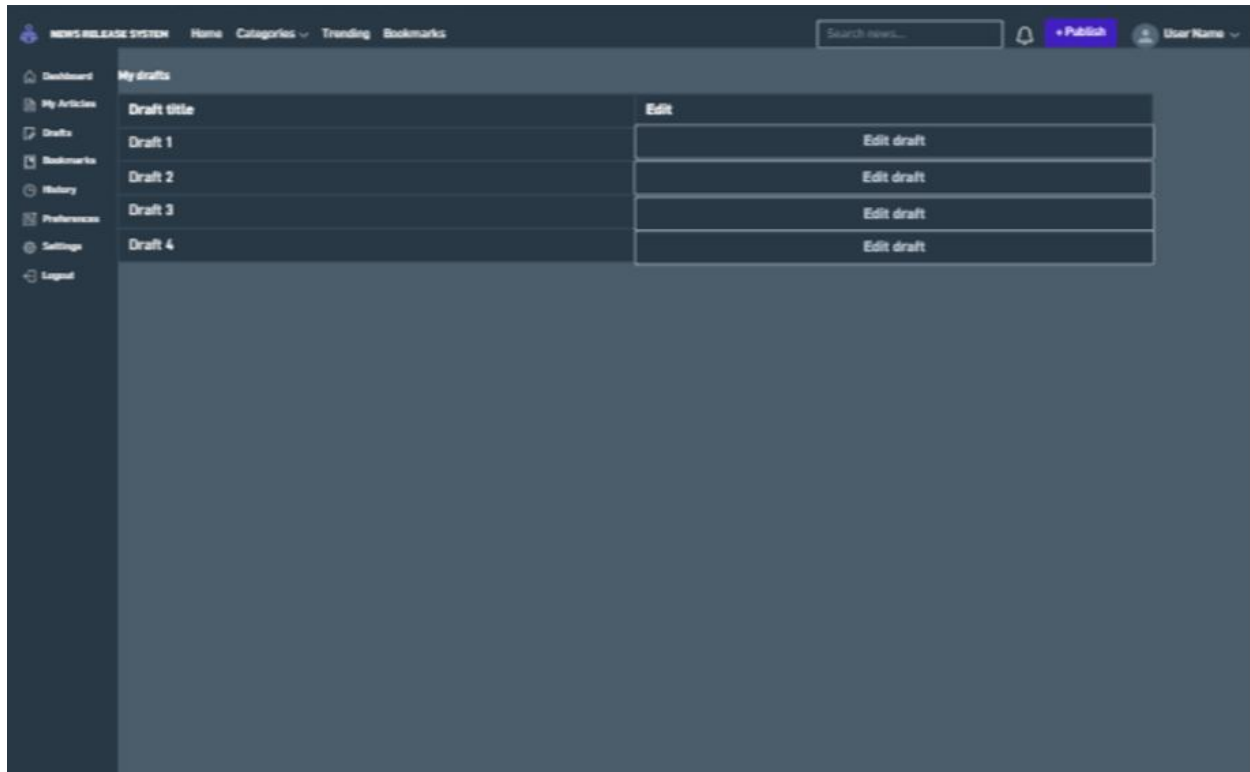
The screenshot shows a web application interface for a 'NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM'. The top navigation bar includes links for 'Home', 'Categories', 'Trending', and 'Bookmarks', along with a search bar and a '+ Publish' button. A sidebar on the left contains links for 'Dashboard', 'My Articles', 'Drafts', 'Bookmarks', 'History', 'Preferences', 'Settings', and 'Logout'. The main content area is titled 'Create/publish article' and contains three input fields: 'Article title' with the placeholder text 'Example article', 'Upload image:' with an 'Upload' button, and 'Article content:' with the placeholder text 'Example content'. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Save as draft' and 'Publish article'.

Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
2. Create a new article or open an article being edited.
3. Enter the required article information and content.
4. Select Save as Draft.
5. The article is saved without being published.
6. The saved article can be accessed later from the Drafts section for further editing.

4.6 Manage Draft Articles

Registered Users can manage their saved draft articles by viewing, editing or deleting drafts before they are published.



Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
2. Navigate to the Drafts section.
3. View the list of saved draft articles.
4. Select the draft article you wish to manage.
5. Select Edit to modify the article, or Delete to remove the draft.

Save any changes made to the draft article.

4.8 Publish or Manage Own News Articles

Registered Users can manage or publish the news articles they have created by viewing, editing or deleting their own published articles.

The first screenshot shows the 'Edit published article' page. It features a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, My Articles, Drafts, Bookmarks, History, Preferences, Settings, and Logout. The main content area has a header 'Edit published article' and a search bar. Below the header, there are input fields for 'Article title' (containing 'Example article') and 'Article content' (containing 'Example content'). An 'Upload image' button is also present. At the bottom, there are two buttons: 'Save changes' (green) and 'Discard changes' (red).

The second screenshot shows the 'Delete published article' page. It features the same sidebar and header. The main content area displays a confirmation dialog box with the text 'Are you sure you want to delete this published article?' and two buttons: 'Yes' (green) and 'No' (red).

Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System.
2. Navigate to My Articles.
3. View the list of articles you have published.

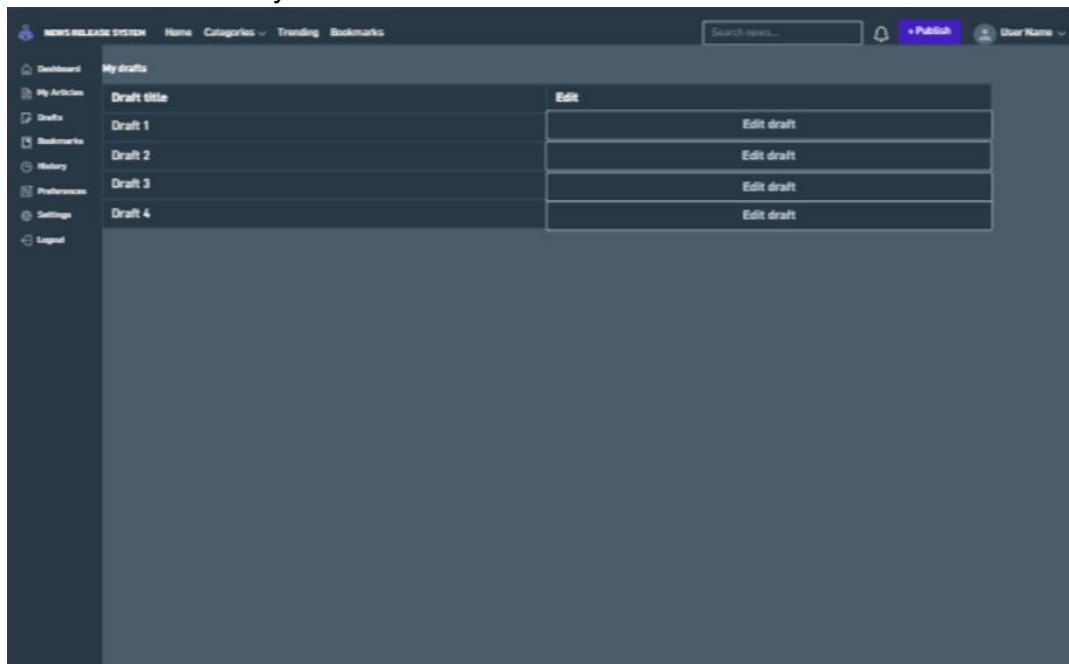
4. Select the article you wish to manage.
5. Select Edit to update the article or Delete to remove it.
6. Save any changes made to the article.
7. Confirm the deletion if prompted.

5. System Admin

This section provides instructions for functions available to the System Admin for managing and maintaining news-related content within the News Release System.

5.1 View News Categories and Tags

The System Admin can view the existing news categories and tags used to organise articles in the News Release System.

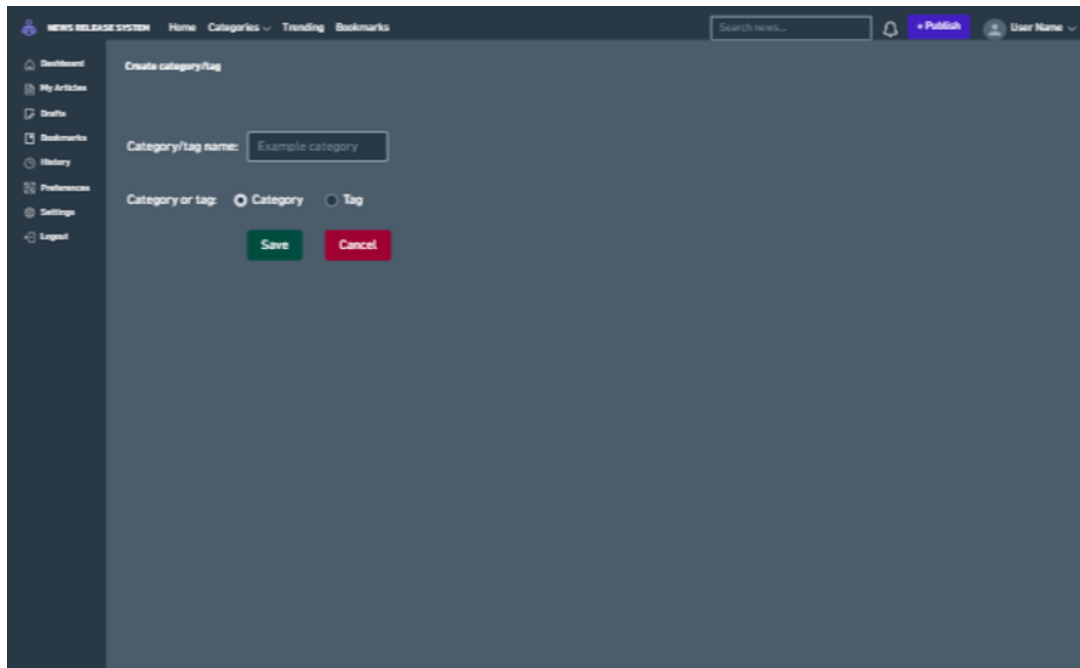


Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the Category and Tag Management section.
3. The system displays the existing news categories and tags.
4. Review the displayed list of categories and tags.

5.2 Create News Categories and Tags

The System Admin can create new news categories and tags to organise articles for users to browse.



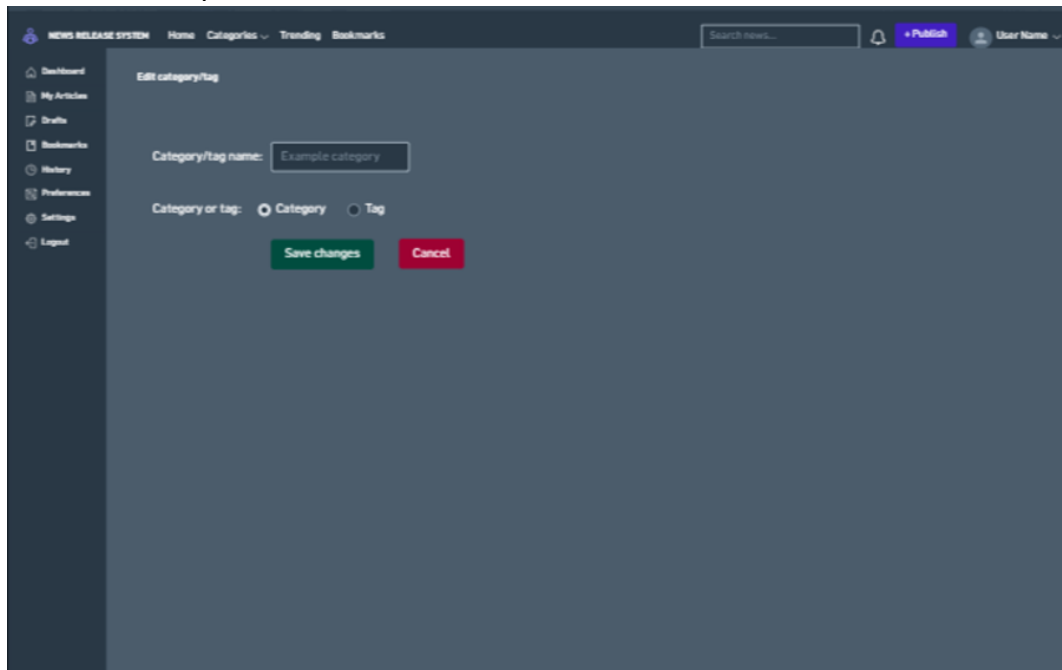
The screenshot shows the 'Create category/tag' form in the News Release System. The form is located in the main content area, with a sidebar on the left containing navigation links: Dashboard, My Articles, Drafts, Bookmarks, History, Preferences, Settings, and Logout. The top navigation bar includes 'NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM', 'Home', 'Categories' (with a dropdown arrow), 'Trending', and 'Bookmarks'. A search bar with the placeholder 'Search news...' is on the right, along with a '+ Publish' button and a 'User Name' dropdown. The form itself has a title 'Create category/tag' and a text input field labeled 'Category/tag name:' with the placeholder text 'Example category'. Below this is a radio button selection for 'Category or tag:', with 'Category' selected and 'Tag' as an option. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: a green 'Save' button and a red 'Cancel' button.

Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the Category and Tag Management section.
3. The system displays the existing news categories and tags.
4. Review the displayed list.

5.3 Edit News Categories and Tags

System Admins can edit existing categories and tags to keep the categorisation system accurate and up to date. .

The screenshot shows the 'Edit category/tag' form in the News Release System. The form is located in the main content area, with a dark sidebar on the left containing navigation links: Dashboard, My Articles, Drafts, Bookmarks, History, Preferences, Settings, and Logout. The top navigation bar includes 'NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM', 'Home', 'Categories', 'Trending', and 'Bookmarks', along with a search bar, a 'Publish' button, and a user profile dropdown. The form itself has a title 'Edit category/tag' and a text input field for 'Category/tag name' containing 'Example category'. Below this is a radio button group for 'Category or tag:' with 'Category' selected. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Save changes' (green) and 'Cancel' (red).

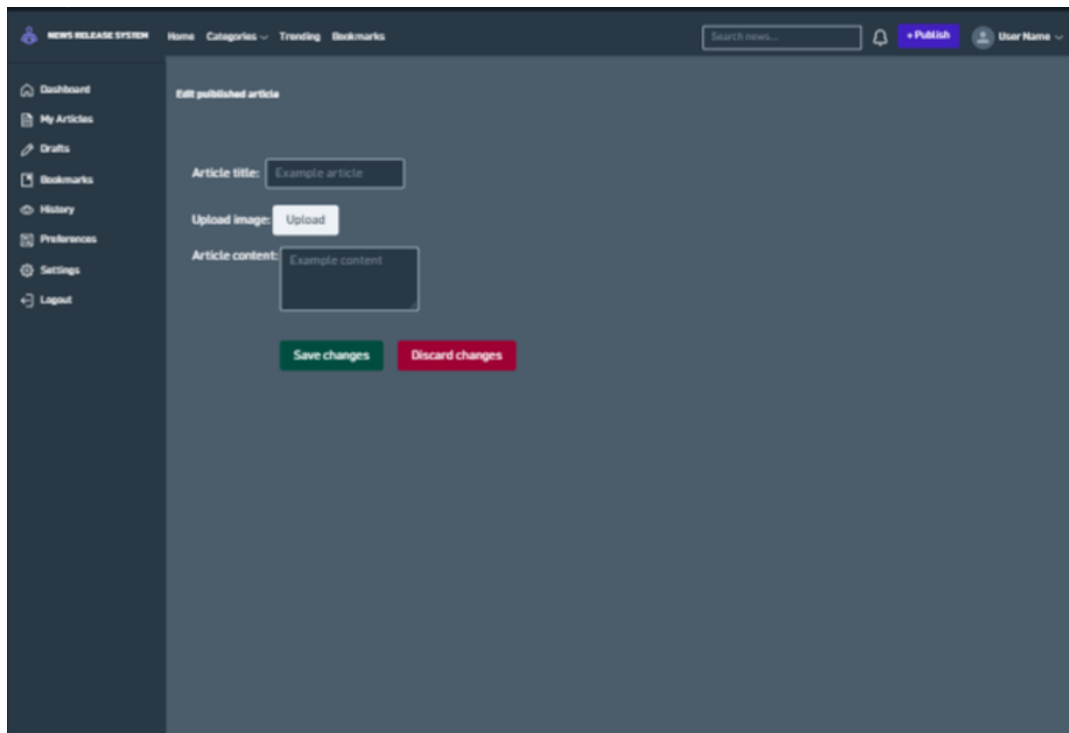
Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the Category and Tag Management section.
3. Locate the category or tag that needs to be updated.
4. Select Edit.
5. Update the required information.
6. Select Save Changes.
7. The system displays the updated list after the changes are successfully saved.

If the updated name already exists, the system displays an error message.

5.4 Delete News Categories and Tags

System Admins can delete categories and tags that are no longer accurate or relevant.



Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the Category and Tag Management section.
3. Locate the category or tag that needs to be removed.
4. Select Delete.
5. Review the deletion confirmation message.
6. Select Confirm.
7. The system removes the category or tag and displays the updated list.

If the category or tag is assigned to an existing article, the system displays a warning before completing the deletion.

5.5 View News Analytics

System Admins can view article statistics and category popularity to understand reader engagement and make informed content decisions.

NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM

HomeCategories ▼TrendingBookmarks

Search news...

+ Publish

User Name ▼

Dashboard

My Articles

Drafts

Bookmarks

History

Preferences

Settings

Logout

Article View Tracking

View the number of views received by each news article.
Click an article title to view detailed analytics.

Sort by: Views (High to Low)Filter

	Article Title	Category	Views	Likes	Comments	Published date
1	 Singapore Launches New National AI Strategy	Technology	17.5K	760	96	May 20, 2026
2	 Local Firms See Growth	Business	11.3K	590	75	May 13, 2026
3	 Singapore Reaches Finals	Sports	10.1K	432	66	May 9, 2026
4	 Singapore Expands Smart Nation Projects	Technology	9.9K	338	51	May 12, 2026
5	 New Digital Services Launch	Lifestyle	8.4K	286	49	May 30, 2026
6	 Simple Habits Improve Well-being	Lifestyle	7.2K	197	43	Apr 26, 2026
7	 Parliament Discusses Support Measures	Politics	6.6K	174	32	Apr 18, 2026
8	 Athletes Prepare for Regional Games	Sports	5.5K	153	30	Apr 4, 2026

← Prev

1

2

3

10

Next →

NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM

HomeCategories ▼TrendingBookmarks

Search news...

+ Publish

User Name ▼

Dashboard

My Articles

Drafts

Bookmarks

History

Preferences

Settings

Logout

Article View Tracking

View the number of views received by each news article.
Click an article title to view detailed analytics.

Sort by: Views (High to Low)Filter

	Article Title	Category	Views	Likes	Comments	Published date
1	 Singapore Launches New National AI Strategy	Technology	17.5K	760	96	May 20, 2026
2	 Local Firms See Growth	Business	11.3K	590	75	May 13, 2026
3	 Singapore Reaches Finals	Sports	10.1K	432	66	May 9, 2026
4	 Singapore Expands Smart Nation Projects	Technology	9.9K	338	51	May 12, 2026
5	 New Digital Services Launch	Lifestyle	8.4K	286	49	May 30, 2026
6	 Simple Habits Improve Well-being	Lifestyle	7.2K	197	43	Apr 26, 2026
7	 Parliament Discusses Support Measures	Politics	6.6K	174	32	Apr 18, 2026
8	 Athletes Prepare for Regional Games	Sports	5.5K	153	30	Apr 4, 2026

← Prev

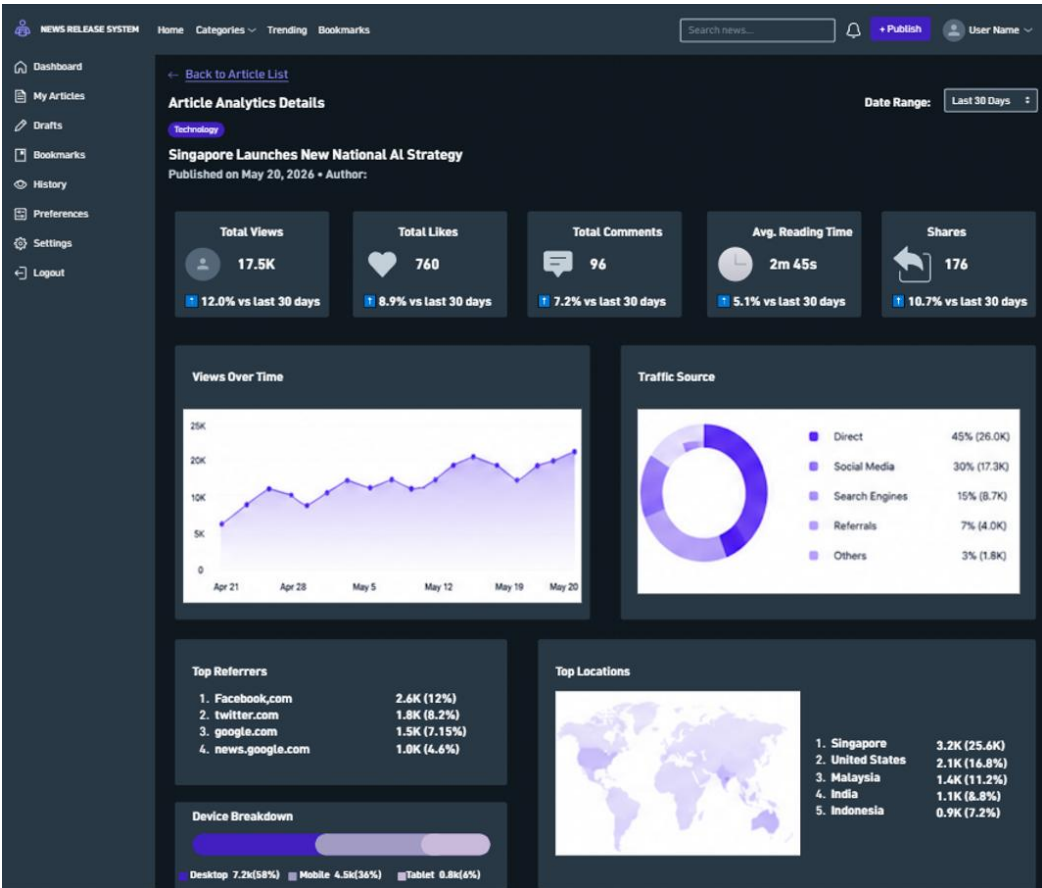
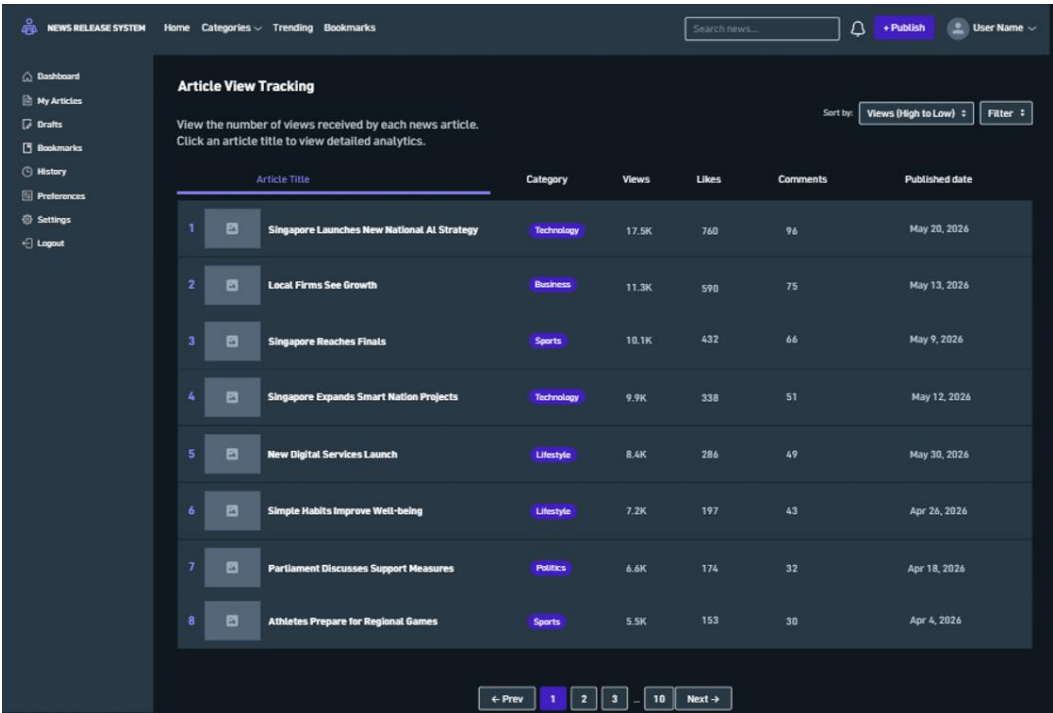
1

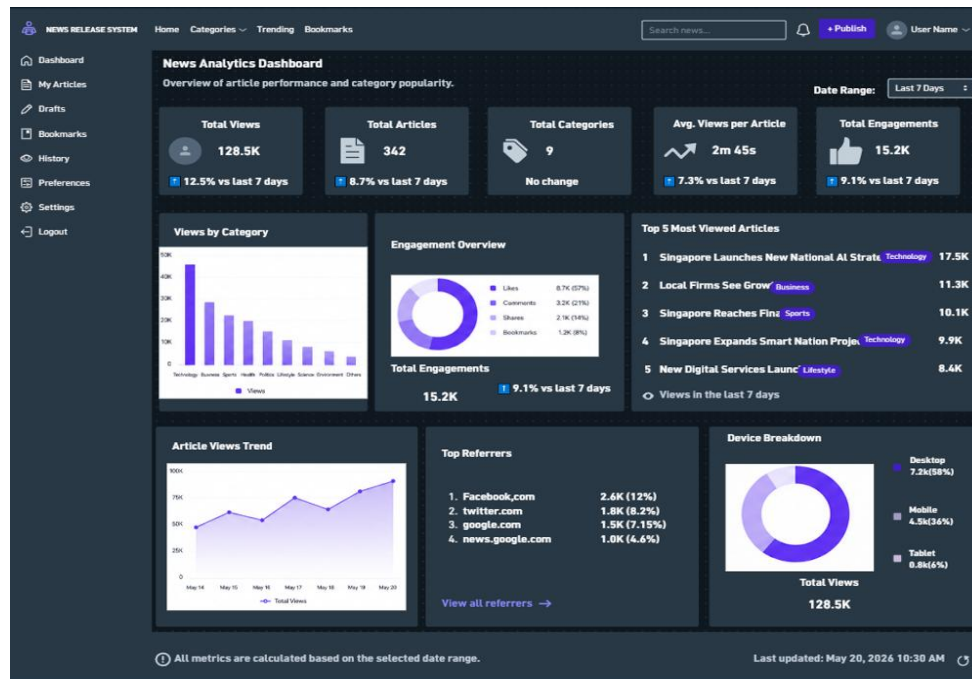
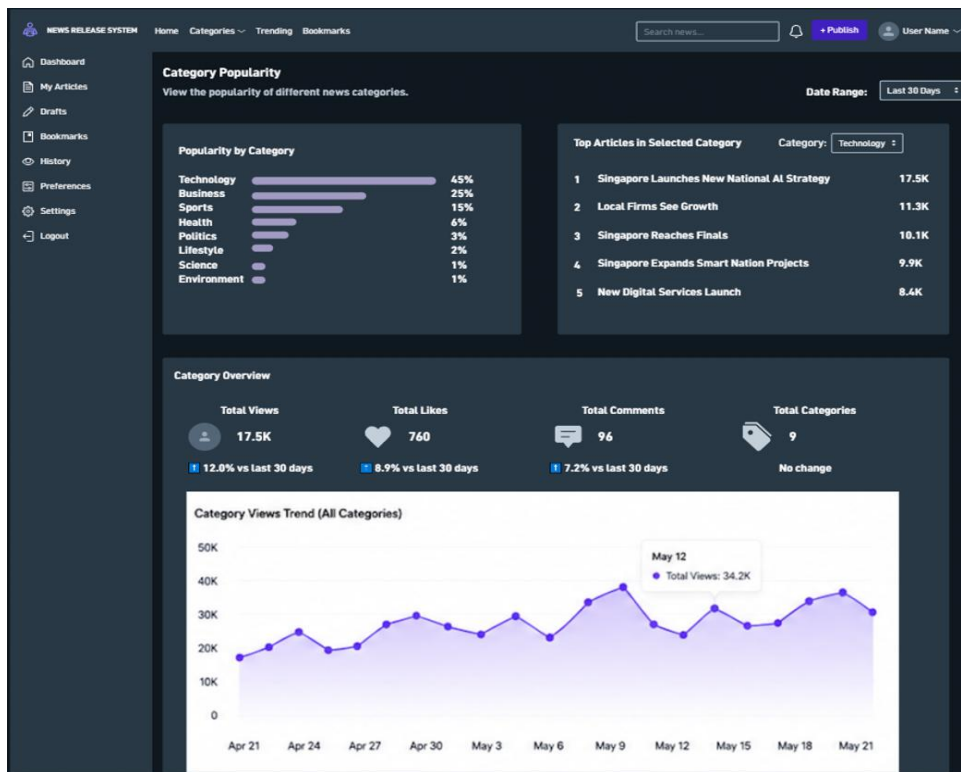
2

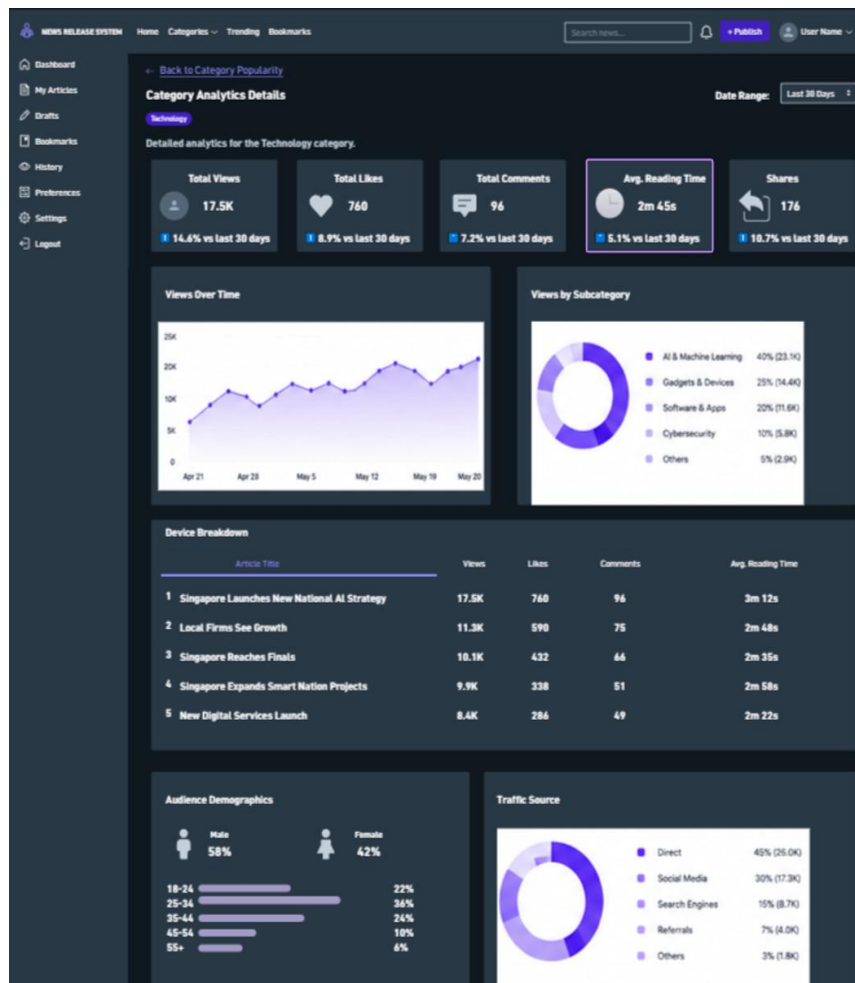
3

10

Next →







Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the Analytics Dashboard.
3. View the statistics for article views and category popularity.
4. Select an article to view its details and total view count.
5. Select a category to view its related articles and statistics.
6. Apply a category or date-range filter if required.
7. Review the displayed analytics results.

If analytics data is unavailable, the system displays a notification indicating that the statistics cannot be generated.

5.6 Manage News Content

System Admins can review and manage news content available within the News Release System.

The first screenshot shows the 'Edit published article' form. It includes a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, My Articles, Drafts, Bookmarks, History, Preferences, Settings, and Logout. The main content area has a header with 'NEWS RELEASE SYSTEM', 'Home', 'Categories', 'Trending', and 'Bookmarks'. A search bar and a '+ Publish' button are also present. The form fields are: 'Article title:' with a text input containing 'Example article', 'Upload image:' with an 'Upload' button, and 'Article content:' with a text area containing 'Example content'. At the bottom are 'Save changes' and 'Discard changes' buttons.

The second screenshot shows the 'Delete published article' confirmation dialog. It features the same sidebar and header. A central modal box asks 'Are you sure you want to delete this published article?' with 'Yes' and 'No' buttons.

Steps:

1. Log in to the News Release System as a System Admin.
2. Open the News Content Management section.
3. Review the list of news articles.
4. Select the article that needs to be managed.
5. Review the article information.
6. Select the required management action.

7. Confirm the action when prompted.
8. The system displays the updated news content list.

3. Troubleshooting

This section provides guidance for resolving common issues that users may encounter while using the News Release System.

Problem	What the User Should Do
I cannot open the website.	Check your Internet connection and refresh the page.
I cannot log in.	Check that the email address and password entered are correct, then try again.
I cannot use bookmarks, reactions or other account features.	Make sure that you are logged in to a Registered User account.
I cannot find the article I am looking for.	Try using a different search keyword or remove some search filters.
No articles appear for a category or tag.	Select another category or tag, as the selected one may not currently contain any published articles.
My news preferences are not showing the content I want.	Open the preference settings, review the selected interests and update them if necessary.
My text size or display mode is not correct.	Open the reading settings and select the preferred text size or light/dark mode again.
I cannot publish my article.	Check that all required article information has been entered before publishing.
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